

1983. This model supported better graphics and higher resolution, taking the gaming experience to a new level. A great shot in the arm for the ailing industry came when Nintendo released Super Mario Bros. – which went on to make the Nintendo Entertainment System (NES) the biggest selling console in North American history.

Another company, Sega came out with their console ‘Master System’ to compete with NES but failed to meet their objective either in America or Japan – two of their pivotal markets.

Nintendo upped the game with a newer version of the Famicom – called the Super Famicom in 1990.



Games for the future!

The next generation of home consoles included 3DO and Atari’s Jaguar. Though impressive in their own rights, neither of them became an actual threat to Sega or Nintendo (By this point, Sega had managed to carve out a decent market share for itself).

Titles like Donkey Kong Country and Star Fox helped Nintendo cement its reputation with the new generation while Sega came out with such titles as Vectorman and Virtua Racing in its race against Nintendo.

But it was Sony’s PlayStation – which was born from a failed attempt at creating a console in conjunction with Nintendo – which became the next big thing in home consoles. Not just that, it became the first ever console to sell more than 100 million units, thereby expanding the video game market dramatically. The 3D graphics that Sony came out with came to be seen as the future of gaming. Also, their CD technology won over multiple developers since the CDs were significantly cheaper to create and easier to distribute as compared to cartridges.